

Mindfulness

Building the observer · The mental entry point

WHO THIS IS FOR

You think in circles. The brain won't stop. Mindfulness builds the observer — the part of you that can notice a thought without becoming it.

■ MORNING — 35 MIN

1	Sunlight exposure Outside within 30 min of waking. No sunglasses. Sets the cortisol rhythm.	5 min
2	Resonance breathing 5.5 sec in / 5.5 sec out. Six breaths per minute. No holds.	10 min
3	Sitting meditation Anchor on breath. When you drift, return. That return is one rep.	20 min

THROUGHOUT THE DAY

4	Mindful anchors Before meals, meetings, transitions. Three breaths. Notice one sensation.	1 min × 3
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■ EVENING — 20 MIN

5	Body scan Feet to crown. Sensation only — no evaluation.	15-20 min
6	Extended exhale 4 sec in / 6-8 sec out. Longer exhale = parasympathetic activation.	5 min

Sleep foundation

7–9 hours · consistent timing · dark and cool

WEEKLY ADDITIONS

Loving kindness Metta meditation	2x/week 20 min	Extended sit One longer session	1x/week 45 min
Mindful walk No headphones, soft focus	3x/week 30 min	Zone 2 cardio Talk-test intensity	3-4x/week 30-45 min
Weekly reflection What did I notice?	1x/week 10 min		

WHAT TO EXPECT

Weeks 1-2

Noticing you've drifted. That's the whole practice.

Weeks 3-4

A gap between trigger and reaction.

Weeks 5-8

Rumination shorter. Observer online.

Week 8+

Noticing before you're gone.

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PRACTICE INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sunlight exposure

5 min · morning

Within 30 min of waking, step outside. No sunglasses. Specialised eye receptors (ipRGCs) signal the brain's master clock, setting the cortisol rhythm. Five minutes clear; 10-20 overcast. Phone screens don't substitute — light levels are too low.

2. Resonance breathing

10 min · morning

Inhale smoothly 5.5 seconds. Exhale smoothly 5.5 seconds. One continuous wave, no pauses, six breaths per minute. At this frequency breath synchronises with cardiovascular rhythm at 0.1 Hz — peak HRV amplitude. The Catholic rosary, Hindu pranayama, and Zen chanting all independently arrived here.

3. Sitting meditation

20 min · morning

Sit upright, eyes soft or closed. Anchor on breath at the nostrils or chest. Thoughts arise — this is not failure, it's the material. The moment you notice you've drifted and return is one rep. You're not trying to think less. You're training the noticing.

4. Mindful anchors

1 min × 3 · through
day

Three fixed moments daily — before meals, meetings, or transitions. Three deliberate breaths. Notice one sensation: a sound, physical feeling, temperature of air. This migrates the practice from cushion to day. Without it, meditation stays a morning ritual.

5. Body scan

15-20 min · evening

Lie on your back, arms slightly away from the body. Bring attention to the feet: temperature, pressure, tingling. Move slowly upward, spending 30-60 seconds per area. Sensation, not evaluation. Builds interoception — the brain's accuracy in reading internal state.

6. Extended exhale

5 min · evening

Inhale 4 seconds, exhale 6-8 seconds. No holds. The longer exhale signals the vagus nerve and activates parasympathetic response. In acute distress this works in under 60 seconds. As evening practice it signals: the day is over.

7. Loving kindness

20 min · 2x weekly

Eyes closed. Begin with yourself. Offer four phrases silently: "May I be well. May I be safe. May I be at ease. May I be happy." Extend outward to someone you love, a neutral person, a difficult person, all beings. Resistance when it arises is the practice, not a sign to stop.

8. Mindful nature walk

30 min · 3x weekly

No headphones. Broaden vision to panoramic. Notice sounds from their direction, the ground underfoot. When a thought pulls you, return. Every step produces bilateral stimulation that quiets circling thoughts. Nature exposure reduces amygdala activation in neuroimaging studies.